

Batasey Non Wood Forest Product Management and Marketing Plan Menchuna Village, Kilkhorthang Gewog



Tsirang Dzongkhag

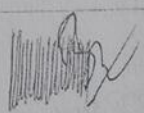
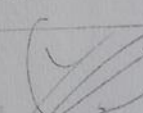
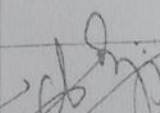
Plan Period: January 2022 to December 2027

Approval Sheet

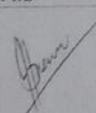
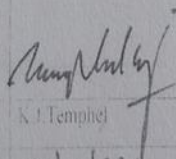
APPROVAL SHEET

Name of NWFPs Management and Marketing Group:	Batasey NWFP Management and Marketing Group
Dzongkhag:	Tsirang
Gewog:	Kilkhorthang
Village(s):	Batasey (Menchuna Chewog)
No. of households:	12
Area (ha)	2.26
Plan Period:	September 2022 – August 2027

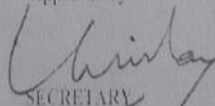
Prepared and submitted for approval

	Chairperson NWFP Management & Marketing Group	Gup of the Gewog	Head, Social Forestry Section of Division/Park	Chief Forestry Officer of Division/Park
Signature:				
Name:	Kishor Chapagai	Beda Moni Chamlagai	Gem Tshering	Chief Forestry Officer Tsirang
Date:	18-11-2022	18-11-2022	21/11/2022	21/11/2022

REVIEWED AND RECOMMENDED FOR APPROVAL

	Reviewing Officer, SFED	Chief forestry Officer, SFED	Head of the Department
Signature:			
Name:	Sonam Peldon	K. J. Tempel	Lobzang Dangi
Date:	20/12/2022	22/12/22	

Approved by



Ministry of Agriculture & Forests

Introduction

The Batasey Non wood forest products (NWFP) Group is located about 2.5 kms away from Damphu town at Menchuna village under Kilkhorthang gewog. The group was initiated in 2011 with the assistance of the Dzongkhag forest staff (DzFS), Tsirang. There were seven (7) group members managing one (1) acre of SRF land adjoining their private registered land. However, group could not progress until 2018. At present, the members increased to 12 and area extended to 4.40 acres of SRF land supplemented by 60 decimal of private registered land. In 2018 with the financial support from Helvetas Bhutan, the group was formally established wherein group members of individual private registered land, were included for management and marketing of broom grass (*Thysanolaena latifolia*). Over the last few years, members have realized the importance of forming group for marketing to generate income. For this, the technical assistance was provided by Tsirang Forest Division. The management plan and bylaws was approved in 2019 by Department Forest and Park Services (DoFPS) for the period of three years.

Based on annual monitoring reports and evaluation of NWFP management, the plan has been revised for next five years As per FNCRR, 2017. In this revision, an area of 20 decimal has been reduced due to developmental activities. Beside this, there are no major revisions. However, we have included all the requirement of NWFP management plan and bylaws as per interim frame work for management and marketing of NWFP, 2011.

NWFP management and marketing plan

Goal:

- Management and utilization of NWFP (broom grass) enhancing cash income opportunities for the group

Objectives:

- ✓ To enhance livelihood and empower women;
- ✓ To develop enterprise through sustainable use of broom grass;
- ✓ To generate employment opportunities for the women and youth;
- ✓ To prevent land degradation through plantation of broom grass;
- ✓ To generate income for the Group and;
- ✓ To explore market and facilitate networking among groups.

Description of NWFPs:

Among the resources optimally used for income generation from forest are Timber and Non Wood Forest Products (NWFPs). NWFPs play an important role in the daily lives and overall wellbeing of Bhutanese people especially in rural areas. Boom grass (NWFP) *Thysanolaena latifolia* has emerged as one of the most widely cultivated cash crop in Tsirang. People use stem and leaves as fodder for livestock and sell inflorescence as broom. Tsirang Dzongkhag has high potential to cultivate on a commercial scale and achieve broom self sufficiency; however, farmers have managed only on small scale, mostly at household level cultivated in small fields and by the side of Farm road.

Table 1: Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting

NWFP name	Harvesting area(s) (name)	Parts harvested	Use purpose (traditional & others)	Harvesting season (months)	Estimated quantity that can be collected¹
Broom Grass	Menchuna	Inflorescence	Soft Broom	December-May	300 head loads
Broom Grass	Menchuna	Leaves	Fodder	December-May	600 head loads
Broom Grass	Menchuna	Stems	Firewood	December-May	300 head loads

Table 2: Harvesting prescriptions for broom grass

	Equipments/tools you will need
	-Hedge clipper -Sickle -carrying materials (rope) Instructions ➤ Harvest broomcorn stalks in the fall, after the green stalks have turned brown;

Harvesting Rules	➤ Cut down the stalks on a sunny day, preferably in the morning after the sun has burned off the dew. Cutting wet broomcorn is harder. Cut the stalks about 6 inches (15cm) above the root with a safe tool such as a hedge cutter. The stalks are thick, and using a knife is more difficult and more dangerous; ➤ Lay the stalks out to dry, leaving about three inches between stalks. The stalks should be dried for the entire day; ➤ Examine the stalks near the end of the drying day and look for the pest on the stalks. If you see pest damage such as significant chewing holes on stalk, throw it away. It is likely that pest is living in the stalk, which weakens it. Throw away stalks showing damage such as severe bends and breaks. Stalks with black spots, which indicates mole, should be discarded. These damaged stalks will not last through the drying process; ➤ Remove the stalks to a dry location such as a garage or barn before nightfall to protect them from moisture. Store them standing up. At this point, it is acceptable for the stalks to touch each other. They can be tied into bundles to save space; ➤ Dry the stalks for at least three weeks. When they are completely dry they are very brittle. Do not store flammable materials near the stalk.
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Map of Broom Grass cultivation area, Batasey NWFP group



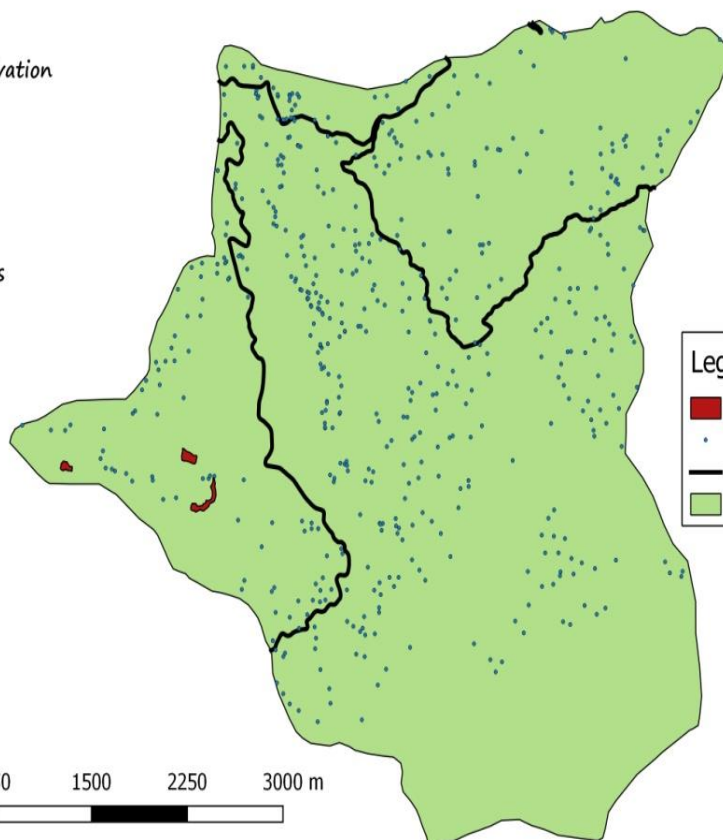
Group has three cultivation
plots:

Plot I: 1 Acre

Plot II: 1.20 Acres

Plot III: 2.20 Acres

Total area: 4.40 acres



Legend

- Broom grass cultivated area
- Settlements
- Roads
- Kilkhorthang Geog

750 0 750 1500 2250 3000 m

Table 3: Marketing and sales plan

<i>NWFP</i>	<i>Potential market</i>	<i>Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)</i>	<i>Expected price per unit</i>	<i>Total (Nu)</i>
Inflorescences (Soft Broom grass)	Damphu Sunday Market	250 numbers of soft broom	25 per bundle	250x25=6250/-
Inflorescences (Soft Broom grass)	Gelephu	350 numbers of soft broom	30 per bundle	350x30=10500/-

Marketing arrangements:

Harvesting and marketing of products in a season shall be done as a group and income generated from individual sale shall be distributed according to the quantity of their products. If the products could not be sold in the local markets, NWFP management committee members shall take products to other Dzongkhags for marketing. Income generated shall be shared based on individual quantity supplied; however, expenditures incurred during marketing shall be born from the sale proceeds before disbursement of income to the members.

Annual Work Plan for the Group:

Activities	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Bush Clearing			✓	✓								
Refilling						✓	✓					
Harvesting	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓							✓
Binding of broom		✓	✓	✓								
Marketing of the broom			✓	✓	✓							

By-laws: Group Regulations and Norms

1. Members of the NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Village	Number of Households	Geog
	Menchuna	12 HHs	Kilkhorthang
	Responsibilities		
	✓ Management of the NWFP (broom grass) ✓ Monitoring of broom grass development activities ✓ attend meeting/contribute labour as and when required ✓ Control cattle from entrance inside NWFP area ✓ Permit to harvest and sale broom as per the agreement and harvesting rules/guidelines		

2. NWFP Management committee

2.1. Chairperson	Mr. Kishor Chapagai
	Responsibilities of chairperson: ✓ Chair the meeting/decision making with members ✓ Resolve disputes ✓ Official correspondence ✓ Arrangement for visitors ✓ Inform members on the date and venue for carrying out the activities regarding NWFP group ✓ Coordinate the sale of NWFP (broom) product and communicate with traders ✓ Submit annual NWFP report

2.2. Secretary	Mrs. Januka Acharya
	✓ Officiate in absence of chairperson ✓ Supervise activities ✓ Keep minutes of meeting ✓ Keep Record of NWFP progress ✓ Assist Treasurer during fund transaction

2.3. Treasure	Mr. Bedanidi Subedi
	✓ Carry out fund transaction ✓ Maintain cash transaction records ✓ Collect membership fees and penalties
2.4. Messenger	Mr. Ram Chandra Acharja: ✓ Pass message on NWFP activities

	✓ Call members for meeting
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Compensation for NWFP Management committee for marketing:

Make payment based on actual expenditure incurred for marketing the products

Utilization of the fund:

The group decided to initiate and contribute certain amount after discussion with all the members on need basis. The fund will be used for following purpose:

- During natural calamities
- Religious ceremony
- Evaluation and Revision of NWFP management and marketing Plan
- Meet expenses during visit of officials and visitors

Membership fee and financial arrangements	• Members will pay the annual membership fee of Nu.200/- • Fund for NWFP development activities shall meet from penalties and membership fees • Collected penalties and fees shall be deposited in group account with BDBL
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Conflict Resolution	➤ Chairperson and secretary shall settle the dispute ➤ Settle the case by Chiwog Tshokpa/Geog Ranger ➤ Geog administration/RO/CFO ➤ Forward to District Court
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Penalties	➤ If the members do not attend meeting or work, he/she shall be fined with Nu. 250/- per occasion. However, those absent for meeting with genuine reasons shall be accepted base on evidences. ➤ Fine shall be collected for letting cattle inside NWFP area as follow:	
	Members	Outsiders
	Fine of Nu.200/cattle shall be collected with written statement and compensate the damage caused to broom grass	Fine of Nu.200/cattle shall be collected with written statement and compensate the damage caused to broom grass
	If members do illegal work inside NWFP area he/she shall replace the damage area and impose fine of Nu.500.	If outsider does illegal work inside NWFP area he/she shall pay fine of Nu.2000/- and Nu. 200/-per clump.

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A. Membership arrangement

- a) Membership opportunity will be given to all farmers of Batasey village under Menchuna Chiwog.
- b) The households who couldn't join the membership and attend during the initiation and in case of separate case (chut-bhai), he/she can become a member after paying the amount equivalent to amount deposited by an individual till date plus Nu.5000/-.
- c) For the people who purchased the land at Batasey under Menchuna and started to settle there and also if she/he is willing to join the group can be join after paying the amount equivalent to amount deposited by an individual till date plus Nu.10,000/-.

B. Benefit sharing

- a) Broom: The product will be sold in the market and divide among members based on their individual effort to produce the product.
- b) Fodder: The fodder will be utilized by the members from the individual plots allotted in the group area (SRF land).

C. Leaving NWFP group

- a) If the members breach the bylaws of the group (NWFP group), he/she shall leave the group only after paying the fine of Nu. 3000/-, without any benefit.
- b) If the member had to leave the group with genuine reason(s) he/she will receive money that is equivalent to the saving bank amount divided among the existing numbers of members on the day of resignation.
- c) Re-joining of the members who had left the group with genuine reason (s) should join the membership after repaying the amount that was taken from the group as incentive and he/she will be treated as new members and shall follow the norms of new members. However, those who left without reason cannot join in what-so-ever reasons. The leaving and re-joining as member will submit application.

D. Financial management

- a) Fund will be utilized for the purchase of tools
- b) Fund will be utilized during any work that arises related to NWFP. (transportation, meetings, visitors.)
- c) No loan will be given to any members

- d) The group will contribute Nu. 2000/- (two thousand) only to any members if there is demise of anyone within the family.
- e) If guest or the visitors' grant donation to the group, the amount will be deposited to the group account.

E. Record keeping

The following records will be kept for monitoring the NWFP marketing activities and proper documentation of NWFP books of accounts and other records.

1. Annual Work plan and progress report
2. Seedling and plantation record
3. Attendance register
4. Record of penalty and compensation
5. Collection Permit
6. Record of NWFP utilization
7. Money Receipt
8. Cash book
9. Bank book
10. Minutes of meeting records
11. Stock register

F. Terms for Executive members

- a) Terms for the executive members will be five years upon which new committees will be elected after completing tenure.
- b) If executive members violate the bylaws or fail to deliver their roles, they will be terminated from the executive members upon repaying the entire amount misused with penalties.

G. Meeting

General meeting will be conducted twice in a year (June and December) months of every year.

H. Miscellaneous

- If there is any Geog development plan which is going to affect the area of NWFP, the concern authority will pay the compensation depending upon the damages cause to the NWFP.
- The NWFP management Group members shall issue no objection letter to concerned authority upon receiving compensation.

Movement and export of NWFPs

- The group shall obtain transit permit from forest office as per FNCRR, 2017
- The export permit shall be issued by forest office
- The exporter shall obtain clearance from BFRA as per rules

Monitoring and Evaluation

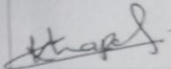
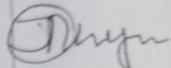
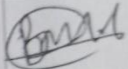
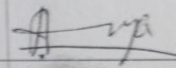
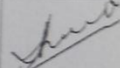
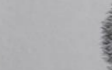
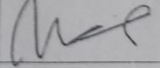
- CFO shall monitor the availability of NWFP on regular basis
- RO/Gewog Ranger shall monitor the implementation of NWFP management & marketing plan to ensure proper records of actual collection and traded records of broom grass
- RO/Gewog Forest Focal shall prepare annual monitoring report
- CFO/RO shall conduct midterm in collaboration with the NWFP Group members
- CFO/RO/Gewog Forest Focal shall conduct final evaluation towards the end of plan period

Powers of Department:

The Department has right to terminate the NWFP management and marketing plan, if the group members violate the provisions of FNCRR, 2017 and amendments, NWFP plan and bylaws.

NWFPM Group Membership List

NWFP MANAGEMENT GROUP MEMBERSHIP

Sl. No.	Name of Household Representative	CID Card No.	House No.	Thram No.	Signature
1.	Kishor chapagai	11805001641	Ba-6-404	816	
2	Januka Acharaya	11305002545	Ba-6-400	877	
3	Bedanidhi Subedi	11805002929	Ba-6-08	208	
4	Puspalal Acharaya	11805001326	Ba-6-03	225	
5	Nima Zangmo	12007000120	Ba-6-246	1132	
6	Loknath Chapagai	11805001645	Ba-6-30	202	
7	Tankanath Chapagai	11805001639	Ba-6-30	202	
8	Kaushila Acharaya	11805001323	B-6-420	1110	
9	Kamala Acharaya	11805001325	Ba-6-419	571	
10	Ugyen Chenzom	1180500164	Ba-6-241	151	
11	Ramchandra Acharya	11805001301	Ba-6-01	751	
12	Lal Bhadur Tamang	11805001379	Ba-6-443	1493	